

PART II.

LOANS BY THE IRISH LAND COMMISSION.

Loan under the Purchase of Land (Ireland) Act, 1885
(48 & 49 Vict. c. 73).

Name of Borrower.	Amount of Loan.	Amount to be written off.
	£ s. d.	£ s. d.
James Reidy - - - -	3,000 0 0	206 1 11

PART III.

LOANS BY THE COMMISSIONERS OF PUBLIC WORKS
IN IRELAND.

Loan under the Public Works (Ireland) Act, 1831
(1 & 2 Will. 4. c. 33).

Name of Borrower.	Amount of Loan.	Amount to be written off.
	£ s. d.	£ s. d.
Dublin Port and Docks Board -	1,700 0 0	1,250 12 10

Loan under the Land Law (Ireland) Act, 1881
(44 & 45 Vict. c. 49. s. 31).

Name of Borrower.	Amount of Loan.	Amount to be written off.
	£ s. d.	£ s. d.
Daniel McKnight - - -	40 0 0	11 12 0

CHAPTER 62.

An Act to make provision for the better protection of
Women and Young Persons against Lead Poisoning.
[23rd December 1920.]

WHEREAS at Washington, on the twenty-eighth day of November, nineteen hundred and nineteen, a general conference of the International Labour Organisation of the League of Nations adopted a Recommendation in the form set out in the Schedule to this Act, and it is expedient that, for the

purpose of carrying out the said Recommendation, the provisions hereinafter contained should have effect :

Be it therefore enacted by the King's most Excellent Majesty, by and with the advice and consent of the Lords Spiritual and Temporal, and Commons, in this present Parliament assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows :

Prohibition of employment of women and young persons in certain processes connected with lead manufacture.

1. It shall not be lawful for any person to employ any woman or young person in any of the following operations :—

- (a) Work at a furnace where the reduction or treatment of zinc or lead ores is carried on :
- (b) The manipulation, treatment, or reduction of ashes containing lead, the desilverising of lead, or the melting of scrap lead or zinc :
- (c) The manufacture of solder or alloys containing more than ten per cent. of lead :
- (d) The manufacture of any oxide, carbonate, sulphate, chromate, acetate, nitrate, or silicate of lead :
- (e) Mixing or pasting in connection with the manufacture or repair of electric accumulators :
- (f) The cleaning of workrooms where any of the processes aforesaid are carried on.

Regulations for employment of women and young persons in processes involving use of lead compounds.

2.—(1) It shall not be lawful for any person to employ in any process involving the use of lead compounds any woman or young person if the process is such that dust or fume from a lead compound is produced therein, or the persons employed therein are liable to be splashed with any lead compound in the course of their employment, unless the following regulations are complied with as respects all women and young persons employed :—

- (a) Where dust or fume from a lead compound is produced in the process, provision must be made for drawing the fume or dust away from the persons employed by means of an efficient exhaust draught so contrived as to operate on the dust or fume as nearly as may be at its point of origin :
- (b) The persons employed must undergo the prescribed medical examination at the prescribed intervals, and the prescribed record must be kept with respect to their health :
- (c) No food, drink, or tobacco shall be brought into or consumed in any room in which the process is carried on, and no person shall be allowed to remain in any such room during meal times :
- (d) Adequate protective clothing in a clean condition shall be provided by the employer and worn by the persons employed :

(e) Such suitable cloak-room, mess-room and washing accommodation as may be prescribed shall be provided for the use of the persons employed :

(f) The rooms in which the persons are employed, and all tools and apparatus used by them, shall be kept in a clean condition.

(2) It shall not be lawful for any person to employ in any process involving the use of lead compounds any woman or young person who has been suspended after medical examination from employment in any such process on the ground that continuance therein would involve special danger to health.

3.—(1) Where an inspector under the Factory and Workshop Act, 1901, suspects that any substance used or intended for use in any process in which women or young persons are employed contains a lead compound, he may at any time take for analysis sufficient samples of that substance.

Power to take
samples.
1 Edw. 7.
c. 22.

(2) If the occupier of the factory or workshop in which any such process is carried on refuses to allow an inspector to take samples in pursuance of this section, or to give him facilities for the purpose, he shall be guilty of obstructing the inspector in the execution of his duties under the said Act :

Provided that the occupier of a factory may, at the time when a sample is taken under this section, and on providing the necessary appliances, require the inspector to divide the sample into two parts and to mark and seal and deliver to him one such part.

(3) In this section the expression "occupier of a factory or workshop" includes any person employing a woman or young person in any process involving the use of lead compounds in any place other than a factory or workshop.

(4) A certificate purporting to be a certificate by the Principal Chemist of the Government Laboratory as to the result of an analysis of a sample under this section shall, in any proceedings under this Act, be evidence of the matters stated therein, unless either party requires the person by whom the analysis was made to be called as a witness.

(5) It shall not be lawful for any person, except in so far as is necessary for the purposes of a prosecution for an offence under this Act, to publish or disclose to any person the results of an analysis made under this Act.

If any person acts in contravention of the provisions of this subsection, he shall be liable on summary conviction to a fine not exceeding fifty pounds.

4. Section seventy-three of the Factory and Workshop Act, 1901 (which requires notification to be sent to the Chief Inspector of Factories of lead poisoning contracted in any

Amendment
of s. 73 of
1 Edw. 7.
c. 22.

factory or workshop), shall apply to lead poisoning contracted by any woman or young person in processes involving the use of lead compounds, whether carried on in factories or workshops or not.

Penalties
where em-
ployment is
not in factory
or workshop.

5. If any person employs a woman or young person in contravention of this Act in any place other than a factory or workshop, he shall be liable on summary conviction to a fine not exceeding twenty pounds, and an inspector appointed under the Factory and Workshop Acts, 1901 to 1911, shall, in relation to the case, have the same powers and duties as if the place in which the woman or young person is employed were a factory or workshop.

Interpreta-
tion.

6. In this Act—

The expression “young person” means a person who is under the age of eighteen years;

The expression “prescribed” means prescribed by order made by the Secretary of State, and the provisions of paragraph (a) of subsection (3) and subsections (4), (6), and (7) of section seven of the Police, Factories, &c. (Miscellaneous Provisions) Act, 1916, shall apply with respect to orders made under this Act as they apply with respect to orders made under that section;

The expression “lead compound” means any soluble compound of lead which is declared by order of the Secretary of State to be a lead compound for the purposes of this Act, and includes a mixture containing any such compound, but does not include an alloy containing lead:

The method of ascertaining whether any compound or mixture is a lead compound within the meaning of this Act shall be such as the Secretary of State may prescribe.

Short title,
construction,
and com-
mencement.

7.—(1) This Act may be cited as the Women and Young Persons (Employment in Lead Processes) Act, 1920, and shall be construed as one with the Factory and Workshop Acts, 1901 to 1911, and this Act and those Acts may be cited together as the Factory and Workshop Acts, 1901 to 1920.

(2) This Act shall come into operation on the first day of January, nineteen hundred and twenty-one.

SCHEDULE.

RECOMMENDATION CONCERNING THE PROTECTION OF WOMEN AND CHILDREN AGAINST LEAD POISONING.

The General Conference recommends to the members of the International Labour Organisation that, in view of the danger involved to the function of maternity and to the physical development of children, women and young persons under the age of eighteen years be excluded from employment in the following processes :—

- (a) In furnace work in the reduction of zinc or lead ores.
- (b) In the manipulation, treatment, or reduction of ashes containing lead, and in the desilverizing of lead.
- (c) In melting lead or old zinc on a large scale.
- (d) In the manufacture of solder or alloys containing more than ten per cent. of lead.
- (e) In the manufacture of litharge, massicot, red lead, white lead, orange lead, or sulphate, chromate, or silicate (frit) of lead.
- (f) In mixing and pasting in the manufacture or repair of electric accumulators.
- (g) In the cleaning of workrooms where the above processes are carried on.

It is further recommended that the employment of women and young persons under the age of eighteen years in processes involving the use of lead compounds be permitted only subject to the following conditions :—

- (a) Locally applied exhaust ventilation, so as to remove dust and fumes at the point of origin.
 - (b) Cleanliness of tools and workrooms.
 - (c) Notification to Government authorities of all cases of lead poisoning, and compensation therefor.
 - (d) Periodic medical examination of the persons employed in such processes.
 - (e) Provision of sufficient and suitable cloakroom, washing, and mess-room accommodation, and of special protective clothing.
 - (f) Prohibition of bringing food or drink into workrooms.
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